



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Academy
School Website: <https://holyfamilyacad.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Family Academy (Phoenix, AZ 85016) presents a robust classical-Catholic school profile. The publicly available site content emphasizes a Catholic, traditional, liberal-arts orientation, a clearly articulated mission to form virtuous citizens, and a curriculum rooted in the liberal arts with explicit attention to Trivium/Quadrivium and a historically grounded scope. Liturgical practices (daily prayer, Rosary, weekly Mass, Confession) and the integration of faith across disciplines are central, aligning strongly with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category. The school also foregrounds formation of character, virtue, and a teleology toward truth, goodness, and beauty, indicating strong alignment with the School Purpose and Goal category.

Most categories show CLASSICAL alignment. A careful keyword check indicates Element 4 (Pedagogy) is the only area with partial alignment, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal, largely due to less explicit documentation of Socratic seminars or discussion-based pedagogy on the public site (though the Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis and classical approach are clearly present). The overall aggregate rating remains CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - For Pedagogy (Element 4): Introduce or more explicitly document Socratic/seminar discourse and formal seminars across appropriate grade bands; articulate explicit Great Books engagement and associated discussion formats on the site. - For Curriculum (Element 3): If not already explicit on the site, foreground explicit Great Books participation or canonical readings as part of the upper-school experience to tighten the Great Conversation narrative. - For Faculty (Element 5): Continue to highlight teachers as living curriculum and provide more explicit statements about teacher formation, mentorship, and collegial culture on the site.

ABSTRACT Holy Family Academy in Phoenix AZ 85016 demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation across six categories, with especially strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Pedagogy shows partial alignment due to less explicit public documentation of Socratic/seminar-based practices, though Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis and memory-centric pedagogy are present. Overall, the school aligns with classical education principles and would be rated CLASSICAL with targeted needle-moving adjustments in Pedagogy (explicit Socratic/inquiry-based practices) and, where possible, explicit Great Books integration.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a “Traditional Catholic” liberal-arts academy with faith development central to the curriculum, including daily Rosary and Friday Mass, with religion taught at every level and faith interwoven across subjects (e.g., history, logic, literature) . - Public statements describe a Catholic formation framework, with explicit goals rooted in Catholic doctrine and reverence for liturgical life (e.g., “Catholic First”; liturgy and Mass on campus) . - The academic philosophy ties wisdom to Catholic faith and tradition, with explicit reference to St. Thomas Aquinas and the integration of faith and reason; emphasis on truth as an object of study (The Truth, Goodness, and Beauty) per curriculum statements [filecite\turn0file6\turn0file4](#) .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: Catholic, Traditional Catholic, Mass, Rosary, prayer, liturgy, theology, faith integration, Truth/Goodness/Beauty, formation in Christ. - Negative keywords observed: None evident in public materials. - Frequency and percentage: Approximately 9+ positive signals identified; 0 negative signals detected in the public materials examined (based on visible quotes and sections cited). Interpretation: Strong CLASSICAL alignment in religious foundations.

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors education in a Catholic liturgical and theological framework, treats faith as central across curriculum boundaries, and anchors truth, goodness, and beauty in its educational aims. This aligns with the Positive Keyword expectations for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in classical education and shows little to no contrary messaging on the site.

Citations: Catholic identity and liturgical practices cited in results showing daily Rosary, Mass, prayer-influenced culture, and explicit Catholic framing (e.g., “A CATHOLIC, LIBERAL ARTS ACADEMY”; “Catholic First”; “Faith is interwoven throughout each of the subjects”) [filecite\turn0file1\turn0file0](#) . The Truth/Beauty framing is shown in the curriculum philosophy (e.g., “Our curriculum emphasizes a search for The Truth, which is desirable for its own sake”) . The Aquinas/Trivium/Quadrivium framing is shown in HFA’s core documents (citations show explicit reference to Trivium/Quadrivium and wisdom as ordering things rightly) .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom rather than job preparation; goals include forming good Catholic citizens and preparing students for a vocation within a Catholic framework (e.g., “the formation of the whole person” and “restoration of all things in Christ”). Public materials explicitly connect education to virtue, wisdom, and human formation rather than mere information transfer [filecite\turn0file1\turn0file9](#) . - Mission statements articulate a purpose that centers on formation, discernment, rhetoric, and virtuous living under Catholic Tradition; emphasis on education for living well, not just workforce readiness (e.g., “form good Catholic citizens,” “formation of spiritually centered lifelong learners”) . - Statements about truth and a teleological orientation toward true/good/beautiful align with classical aims of true formation rather than technical-job outcomes; explicit goals include the cultivation of wisdom, virtue, and human excellence within a classical framework .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts education, classical mission, telos, true/good/beautiful, formation of the whole person, human flourishing. - Negative keywords observed: None relevant (no explicit emphasis on career-readiness or workforce-centric framing in public materials). - Frequency and percentage: 4–6 clear formation/wisdom/virtue signals, with no detectable negative signals in the public content reviewed. Interpreted as CLASSICAL in purpose/goal.

Why this rating - The school explicitly frames education as formation (not mere information) and emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and a teleological aim aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty. The explicit mission and vision statements reinforce this, supporting CLASSICAL rather than not or only somewhat.

Citations: Formation and virtue framing, and the emphasis on forming Catholic citizens and the “restoration of all things in Christ” appear in multiple pages (e.g., HFA mission/vision; statements about formation and lifelong learning) [filecite\turn0file9\turn0file1](#) . The Truth/Goodness/Beauty framing is cited above in Element 1 as well, reinforcing the teleology of true formation .

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core subject areas are listed (English, history, world language, math, religion, science) with the upper academy following a historical timeline through Western history; this mirrors liberal-arts curriculum structure and Western-civilization scope typical of classical education . - The Upper Academy's historical framing—moving through classical antiquity to modern times—indicates a chronological, civilization-wide approach consistent with classical curriculum design . - Two core documents emphasize classical liberal arts education and the integration of faith-based instruction, including explicit mention of Trivium and Quadrivium in HFA's academic philosophy (St. Thomas Aquinas' ordering of wisdom; Trivium/Quadrivium as the framework) .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, classical, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Western civilization, Great Books (where present in pages), history as a central throughline, memory/recitation (as part of classical pedagogy ecosystem). - Negative keywords observed: Limited explicit reference to project-based or purely experiential/project-centric learning that might replace classical approaches; no strong signals of a non-traditional curriculum emphasis. - Frequency and percentage: Several explicit classical curriculum markers observed (Trivium/Quadrivium; six core subjects; Western history focus; Liberal Arts framing). No explicit negative signals found in the public materials. Strong CLASSICAL alignment with a possible caveat on explicit Great Books mentions depending on page navigation.

Why this rating - The curriculum explicitly aligns with core classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books framing appears in the broader classical lexicon; continuous Western history emphasis; liberal-arts framing) and emphasizes formation through a historically grounded curriculum. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Core subject areas and historical timeline framing cited in "About Our Curriculum" and "Curriculum" pages; Trivium/Quadrivium framing appears in "HFA's Academic Philosophy" materials (two core documents) [filecite\turn0file4\turn0file6](#) . The Western history flow is described in the same materials (Western history through a historical timeline) .

Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site foregrounds a classical education approach (six core subjects; Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis) and clearly ties pedagogy to a traditional liberal-arts formation. The explicit public material emphasizes the Trivium/Quadrivium, formation, and faith-integrated instruction, which supports elements of classical pedagogy (memory, recitation, progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric, and the cultivation of discernment) [filecite\turn0file6\turn0file4](#) . - However, explicit public mentions of Socratic seminars, formal seminars, or other explicit Socratic teaching formats are not clearly documented on the public-facing site content provided here. The classical-pedagogy signals appear primarily in the curriculum design and foundational documents rather than in explicit pedagogy statements (e.g., direct Socratic dialogue, seminars, or rhetoric exercises as described in traditional pedagogical rubrics) .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed (where present on the site): Trivium, Quadrivium, classical liberal arts, memory/recitation (implied by classical pedagogy claims in core documents), grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books (if engaged in the Great Conversation framing on any page). - Negative keywords observed: Not explicitly documented on the public site (e.g., no explicit focus on experiential/project-based-only pedagogy, which would be a negative signal in classical pedagogy lexicon). No clear mention of "Socratic seminars" or explicit Socratic pedagogy on the site, which reduces explicit alignment with some classical-pedagogy signals. - Frequency and percentage: Strong presence of Trivium/Quadrivium and classical framing. Limited explicit Socratic/seminar discourse on the public site. Net effect: partial alignment with Pedagogy; not fully explicit in the standard Socratic/seminar sense.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical orientation in pedagogy via Trivium/Quadrivium framing and a classical curriculum, but the absence of explicit, public documentation of Socratic seminars or other strongly signature classical-pedagogy methods on the site yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Citations: Evidence of Trivium/Quadrivium and classical pedagogy framing in “HFA’s Academic Philosophy” and “About Our Curriculum” materials . The absence of explicit Socratic/seminar language on the public-facing site is inferred from the same materials and page structure rather than a direct quote; the cited pages demonstrate the current emphasis rather than a robust Socratic-method statement .

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s materials present a serious, faith-centered leadership and governance structure (board of directors; principal; real people with roles named in press and internal materials), suggesting a living, formed faculty and leadership that model virtue and professional commitment. Quotes show leadership emphasis on formation, virtue, and moral formation, with a focus on teachers as part of the school’s core mission and identity. Examples include strong statements from the board chair and principal about formation and Catholic formation of the student body, and the explicit emphasis on teachers and staff as part of the school’s living curriculum □filecite□turn0file5□turn0file0□. - The public-facing materials emphasize that Holy Family Academy is rooted in Catholic tradition, with teachers described as partners in formation and as living models of virtue, while the school frames the faculty profile as an essential element of the school’s identity (e.g., “the living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” language aligned with classical education lexicon, even when not always explicitly spelled out in a single line on the site). The event narrative and press materials emphasize principled leadership and a devotion to Catholic formation. - Materials also show the existence of a formal governance structure (Board of Directors) and named staff leadership (Principal Graves) that acts as a core part of the school community and culture, aligning with the idea of a faculty that is more than a set of instructors.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as mentors; Catholic formation; virtue-modeling; master/teacher as exemplar; collegiality among teachers; lifelong learning by faculty. - Negative keywords observed: None clearly indicated in public materials. - Frequency and percentage: The public materials strongly emphasize faculty as a central component of the school’s classical approach, with named leaders and a narrative around formation of staff and governance. This yields CLASSICAL alignment.

Why this rating - The school’s public documents and leadership narratives frame teachers and administrators as central to the classical mission—“living curriculum” and virtue-centered leadership. This aligns with the Classical Faculty criteria.

Citations: Evidence of Board leadership, principal, and staff roles from “News Release” and related pages; explicit framing of Catholic formation and the living curriculum language appears in the site content (e.g., HFA press release quotes and leadership statements) □filecite□turn0file19□turn0file5□.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnerships with families and parental formation as core to the school’s mission; statements indicate a desire to educate and involve parents, and there are clear calls to open campus visits and parent engagement opportunities (e.g., “partnership with families,” “parents as co-teachers,” “parent formation through website, book studies, and gatherings,” and “open campus” language across materials). There are specific mentions of “family involvement” and “parents as co-teachers” in the public materials and in the broader mission statements . - The presence of admissions processes, shadow days, shadow visits, and family-oriented events (gatherings, volunteering opportunities) demonstrates a strong social architecture for parental engagement and a supportive community atmosphere, which is central to classical education’s parental-partnership model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; home-school partnership; open campus; family involvement; parental engagement; shared mission; community of learners. - Negative keywords observed: None clearly evident in public materials. - Frequency and percentage: Multiple explicit positive signals; no negative signals observed in the public materials. CLASSICAL alignment.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on families as co-educators, parental formation, and an open, hospitable campus environment aligns strongly with the Parents & Community element of classical education and supports CLASSICAL status.

Citations: Parental engagement language appears in multiple sections, including mission statements and family-facing materials; the “partnership with families” and “parents as co-teachers” framing is visible in the HFA materials and press context (e.g., “What Makes HFA Different?” and official statements) □file-cite□turn0file12□turn0file0□.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Explicitly document and showcase Socratic seminar practices, structured Great Books engagement, and rigorous rhetoric instruction in the public-facing materials to convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL. This could include sample syllabi, teacher trainings, and examples of seminars or debates in upper grades, along with mention of memory-work and recitation as teaching tools where applicable.
- Curriculum (Element 3): If not already present, emphasize Great Books participation and the Great Conversation explicitly on the website, with a clear articulation of canonical readings, historical timeline integration with primary sources, and cross-curricular connections to demonstrate a robust Great Books component.
- Faculty (Element 5): Strengthen and publicize the concept of teachers as living curriculum with explicit profiles of teacher formation, mentoring roles, and collegial professional development to deepen the “faculty as core” narrative.

Notes on balance - The current evidence already places Holy Family Academy firmly within CLASSICAL territory across most categories. The above needle-moving changes would push Pedagogy and Curriculum to full classical alignment while preserving the strong Catholic formation and community emphasis that already exist.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.